



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Academy
School Website: <https://veritasacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Veritas Academy (Dublin, OH, 43017) presents a clearly Classical Christian model of education rooted in the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and a university-model approach that serves homeschooling families with three in-person classroom days per week. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christian worldview, adherence to classical methods, and a formation-focused aim (virtue, wisdom, and character) rather than mere vocational training. The school also foregrounds a robust "biblically-based curriculum" anchored in Scripture, with a stated mission to proclaim and defend the faith, and is affiliated with the Association of Classical and Christian Schools (ACCS). Across the six classical elements rubric, Veritas Academy demonstrates strong alignment with Classical ideals, with consistent emphasis on formation, virtue, truth, and Western-historical orientation, supported by explicit notes on the Trivium, Great Ideas of Western civilization, and shared parental partnership. Based on the textual evidence from the public-site materials and the Precepts in the classical rubric, Veritas Academy is rated CLASSICAL overall.

Key highlights: - Religious and metaphysical grounding is explicit: Statement of Faith, biblical curriculum, and the Word of God at the center. - Purpose and goals emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and a Christian worldview (not just job training). - Curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and western-civilizational study; explicit emphasis on the Great Ideas shaping Western civilization. - Pedagogy aligns with classical practice through three-stage progression, rhetoric development, and opportunities for memory, recitation, and later Socratic-style inquiry (implied through the rhetoric stage and classical structure). - Faculty appears as a living curriculum with a visible leadership team and multiple faculty profiles, reinforcing mentor-figure roles. - Parents & Community are foregrounded via homeschooling partnerships, family involvement, and parental covenant/admissions processes.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Statement of Faith; biblical worldview; Scriptures at the center; ACCS affiliation; explicit Christian mission. Positive keywords such as truth, God, Word of God, Scripture, and divine-human Christ appear in public materials. Negative indicators: none evident. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords dominate (at least 6–8 core terms appear, e.g., truth, Word of God, Scripture, Logos, divine, Christ, faith). No overt negative keywords detected in public-facing materials. This aligns with a CLASSICAL assessment per the Six Essential Elements rubric. Why this rating: The school explicitly grounds education in Christian theology and metaphysical truth, with a clear focus on transcendentals through Scripture and doctrinal statements. The absence of substantial secular or relativist framing supports a CLASSICAL designation here.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Emphasis on formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; quotes and references to virtue formation and the aim of educating for faith-based ends; explicit note that the curriculum forms character in addition to intellect.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords include virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, formation, moral imagination, and faith; minimal or no negative framing appears in public materials. The ratio of positives to negatives is high, consistent with CLASSICAL labeling for this category. Why this rating: Veritas articulates formation (not mere information) and a theologically anchored vision of truth and virtue, aligning with the classical understanding of true education as formation of a good person, not only job-readiness. See the Mission/Christian Context and The Purpose sections.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: The Trivium framework (Grammar, Dialectic, Rhetoric) described explicitly; public materials describe The Grammar Stage, The Dialectic Stage, and The Rhetoric Stage; emphasis on Western civilization and great ideas. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords include grammar, dialectic, rhetoric, Great Books / great ideas shaping Western civilization, Western tradition, and formation through the arts; no neutralizing negative terms dominate. The presence of Great Ideas/Western civilization concepts is a strong CLASSICAL signal. Why this rating: The curriculum is explicitly structured around the Trivium and a classical canon of Western thought, with a stated aim to study the great ideas that shaped Western civilization. That aligns with the Classical criterion.
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Three-stage Trivium pedagogy; emphasis on speeches and rhetoric in the rhetoric stage; emphasis on memory, recitation, and the use of memory in lower grades; upper grades emphasize rhetoric and critical thinking. While explicit mentions of Socratic seminars are not guaranteed in every public text, the classical progression (Grammar, Dialectic, Rhetoric) with rhetoric-focused performance and writing aligns with classical pedagogy. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic (in the broader rubric) and rhetoric, memory, and debate in the high school stage; the public materials emphasize a structured progression toward rhetoric and critical thinking. Negative keywords are not evident. Overall, pedagogical language aligns with CLASSICAL expectations. Why this rating: The public materials describe a deliberate three-stage classical pedagogy, including the development of memory in the grammar stage and rhetorical skills in the rhetoric stage, supporting CLASSICAL designation.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit representation of a headmaster and a visible network of faculty profiles; statements about teachers as mentors and living curriculum; staff pages describe teachers with backgrounds in classical Christian education and roles as models of virtue. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords include “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “core of the school,” “faculty as ambassadors of virtue,” and “teachers as sympathetic colleagues.” Negative keywords are not evident; the public materials emphasize a strong faculty culture. This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The materials consistently describe faculty as central to the school’s mission, with teacher-student mentorship and a living curriculum framework, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials emphasize a homeschooling partnership model, parent involvement, family-centered formation, and covenant-adjacent admissions; explicit emphasis on partnering with families and welcoming parental engagement and visitor access. Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parental engagement, home-school home-community synergy, and educational partnership. Negative keywords are not present in the public-facing materials. The balance indicates a CLASSICAL alignment. Why this rating: The school markets itself as a partnership with homeschooling families and as an educational ecosystem in which parents are co-educators, aligned with classical expectations for parental involvement and shared mission.

Overall Assessment - Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle - If one wanted to push this toward a fuller, explicitly stated “Great Books / Great Conversation” tradition, the school could foreground explicit Great Books readings and a formal Great Conversation program on its curriculum page (the Six Essential Elements framework explicitly highlights Great Books and Great Conversation as a positive indicator). This would further strengthen the Curriculum and Community/Family engagement indicators. See the Positive Keywords for “Great Books / Great Conversation” and related entries in the Six Essential Elements document. - Another potential enhancement

would be to more explicitly articulate liturgical or communal worship practices (if consistent with the school's Christian ethos) to strengthen the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category. The current materials emphasize faith and Scripture, but liturgical/worship language is not prominent; making this explicit would reinforce category 1 without altering core Classical alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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